NEXORA SOLUTIONS

Employee Handbook

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Human Resources Department

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1. Welcome & Company Overview

A Message from Leadership

Welcome to Nexora Solutions. Whether you are joining us as a new hire or have been part of our journey for some time, this handbook is designed to help you understand who we are, how we work, and what you can expect from us as an employer. We are proud of the culture we have built together, and we are glad to have you as part of it.

Nexora Solutions was founded in 2014 with a simple mission: to help mid-sized businesses modernize their operations through practical, well-engineered software. Over the past decade, we have grown from a five-person team working out of a shared office in Pune to a company of approximately 150 employees across three locations, serving clients in the logistics, retail, and financial services sectors.

Our Mission

To build reliable, scalable software that solves real operational problems for our clients, while fostering a workplace where employees can do their best work and grow their careers.

Our Core Values

- **Ownership** — We take responsibility for outcomes, not just tasks.
- **Transparency** — We communicate honestly, even when the news is difficult.
- **Respect** — We treat colleagues, clients, and partners with dignity and fairness.
- **Continuous Improvement** — We look for better ways to work, every quarter.
- **Client Focus** — We measure our success by the outcomes we deliver for the people who use our products.

Company Structure

Nexora Solutions is organized into five departments: Engineering, Product, Client Services, Sales & Marketing, and Operations (which includes Human Resources, Finance, and IT). Each department is led by a Department Head who reports to the Executive Leadership Team. Our head office is located in Pune, Maharashtra, with satellite offices in Bengaluru and a fully remote engineering pod supporting clients in European time zones.

How to Use This Handbook

This handbook applies to all full-time and part-time employees of Nexora Solutions, unless a specific policy states otherwise. Contractors and interns should refer to their individual engagement letters, as certain sections of this handbook (particularly leave and benefits) may not apply to them. Policies in this handbook are reviewed annually by Human Resources and may be updated from time to time; employees will be notified of material changes by email and given at least 15 days' notice before a revised policy takes effect.

2. Code of Conduct

Nexora Solutions is committed to maintaining a professional, respectful, and safe workplace for all employees. This section outlines our expectations regarding dress code, workplace behavior, and our zero-tolerance policy on harassment and discrimination.

Dress Code

Nexora Solutions follows a **smart casual** dress code on regular working days. Employees are expected to dress in a manner that is neat, professional, and appropriate for a client-facing technology company.

- **Monday to Thursday:** Smart casual attire is expected (collared shirts, blouses, tailored trousers, chinos, or equivalent). Clean, well-maintained sneakers are acceptable.
- **Friday:** Casual Friday allows jeans and casual T-shirts, provided they are free of offensive graphics or language.
- **Client meetings and external events:** Business formal attire is required, regardless of the day of the week.
- **Prohibited items:** Beachwear, sleepwear, clothing with offensive or discriminatory language or imagery, and attire that is unsafe for the workplace (e.g., open-toe footwear in hardware/lab areas).

Employees working remotely are expected to dress in smart casual attire for all video calls with clients and in professional attire for internal video calls, at a minimum.

Workplace Behavior

All employees are expected to conduct themselves with professionalism, courtesy, and integrity. This includes:

- Treating colleagues, clients, vendors, and visitors with respect, regardless of role, seniority, or background.
- Being punctual for meetings and responsive to reasonable work communications during business hours.
- Maintaining a clean and organized workspace, whether in-office or at home.
- Refraining from the use of intoxicating substances during work hours or while representing the company at client or public events.
- Avoiding conflicts of interest, and disclosing any outside employment, consulting arrangements, or financial interests that could reasonably conflict with Nexora's business.
- Protecting company property, confidential information, and client data at all times (see Section 7 for detailed IT and security expectations).

Anti-Harassment and Anti-Discrimination Policy

Nexora Solutions maintains a strict **zero-tolerance policy** toward harassment, discrimination, and retaliation of any kind. This applies to interactions between employees, as well as interactions with clients, vendors, and visitors.

Harassment includes, but is not limited to, unwelcome verbal or physical conduct based on a person's gender, gender identity, sexual orientation, religion, caste, disability, age, marital status, or nationality. This includes sexual harassment as defined under applicable law, including unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, and other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature.

Reporting Procedure

Employees who experience or witness harassment or discrimination are encouraged to report it immediately through any of the following channels:

- Directly to their reporting manager (unless the manager is the subject of the complaint);
- To the Human Resources Business Partner assigned to their department;
- To the Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) at icc@nexorasolutions.example, constituted in accordance with applicable workplace harassment law;
- Anonymously, via the confidential ethics hotline listed on the company intranet.

All complaints will be investigated promptly, confidentially, and impartially, typically within 30 days of being reported. Retaliation against anyone who reports a concern in good faith, or who participates in an investigation, is strictly prohibited and will itself be treated as a disciplinary matter, up to and including termination.

3. Employment Basics

Work Hours

Standard working hours at Nexora Solutions are **9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, Monday through Friday**, inclusive of a one-hour lunch break, totaling 40 hours per week. Departments with client obligations in different time zones (e.g., the European engineering pod) may follow adjusted schedules of **1:00 PM to 10:00 PM IST**, as agreed with their manager.

Nexora operates a **flexible start-time window** between 8:30 AM and 10:30 AM, provided employees complete a full 8-hour workday (excluding lunch) and are available during the core collaboration hours of 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM, when most internal meetings are scheduled.

Attendance

Employees are expected to record attendance daily using the company's HR portal (NexoraHR). Employees who anticipate being late by more than 30 minutes, or who need to leave early, should inform their manager in advance where possible.

- Three or more unapproved late arrivals in a calendar month may result in a documented conversation with the reporting manager.
- Unauthorized absence for 3 consecutive working days without notice may be treated as job abandonment, subject to the process outlined in Section 6.
- Attendance records are reviewed monthly by Human Resources and form part of an employee's performance record.

Remote Work Eligibility

Nexora Solutions operates a **hybrid work model**. Employees are expected to work from the office on **Tuesday, Wednesday, and Thursday**, with the option to work remotely on Monday and Friday, subject to team requirements and manager approval.

- **Fully remote roles:** Certain roles (e.g., the European engineering pod, and employees hired under a remote-first offer letter) are exempt from in-office requirements and may work remotely on a full-time basis.
- **Occasional remote work:** Employees may request up to 5 additional remote days per month beyond the standard hybrid schedule, subject to manager approval, for personal circumstances (e.g., medical appointments, home repairs, travel).
- **Eligibility criteria:** Employees must have completed their probation period (see below) and maintained satisfactory performance to be eligible for extended remote work arrangements.
- **Equipment:** Employees working remotely are expected to maintain a stable internet connection (minimum 25 Mbps) and a quiet, professional environment for calls. Nexora provides a one-time home office setup allowance of ■15,000 for employees in fully remote roles.

Probation Period

All new employees join on a probationary period of **90 days** from their date of joining. During this period, either party may terminate the employment relationship with **7 days' written notice**. Performance and cultural fit are

formally reviewed with the employee's manager at the 45-day and 90-day marks. Upon successful completion of probation, the employee is confirmed in their role and the standard notice period (Section 6) applies going forward.

Working Hours for Part-Time Employees

Part-time employees work a minimum of 20 hours per week, as defined in their individual offer letters. Leave entitlements for part-time employees are calculated on a pro-rata basis relative to the full-time entitlements described in Section 4.

4. Leave Policy

Nexora Solutions provides a structured leave policy to support employee well-being and work-life balance. The leave year runs from **January 1 to December 31**. All leave categories are pro-rated for employees who join partway through the calendar year.

Summary of Annual Leave Entitlements

Leave Type	Days per Year	Carry-Forward
Casual Leave (CL)	8 days	Not carried forward
Sick Leave (SL)	10 days	Up to 5 days carried forward
Annual / Earned Leave (EL)	18 days	Up to 15 days carried forward
Public Holidays	12 days (as per annual calendar)	Not applicable
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	Not applicable
Paternity Leave	15 calendar days	Not applicable
Bereavement Leave	5 days per event	Not applicable
Marriage Leave	3 days (one-time, self)	Not applicable

Casual Leave

Employees are entitled to **8 days** of casual leave per calendar year, intended for short-notice personal matters. Casual leave may be taken in half-day increments and should be applied for through NexoraHR at least 1 day in advance where the need is foreseeable. No more than 3 consecutive days of casual leave may be taken at a time without prior approval from the department head.

Sick Leave

Employees receive **10 days** of paid sick leave per year. For absences of 3 or more consecutive days, a medical certificate from a registered practitioner must be submitted through NexoraHR within 3 working days of returning to work. Unused sick leave, up to a maximum of 5 days, may be carried forward into the following calendar year; any balance beyond that is forfeited.

Annual (Earned) Leave

Employees accrue **18 days** of annual leave per year, credited at a rate of 1.5 days per completed month of service. Annual leave requests should be submitted at least 5 working days in advance for periods of up to 3 days, and at least 15 working days in advance for longer periods, to allow for adequate handover planning. A maximum of **15 days** of unused annual leave may be carried forward to the next calendar year; any excess is

either forfeited or, at the company's discretion, encashed at the employee's basic daily salary rate, subject to a cap of 10 days.

Public Holidays

Nexora Solutions observes **12 public holidays** per year, aligned with national and regional holidays applicable to each office location. The holiday calendar is published on the company intranet by December 1 of the preceding year. Employees required to work on a gazetted public holiday due to client obligations are entitled to a compensatory day off within the following 30 days.

Maternity and Paternity Leave

Nexora Solutions provides **26 weeks** of paid maternity leave, in line with applicable law, for employees who have completed at least 80 days of service in the 12 months preceding their expected delivery date. Paternity leave of **15 calendar days** is available to be taken within 3 months of the child's birth or adoption. Adoptive parents are entitled to the same leave benefits as biological parents, calculated from the date the child is placed with the family.

Bereavement and Marriage Leave

Employees are entitled to **5 days** of paid bereavement leave in the event of the death of an immediate family member (spouse, parent, child, or sibling), and **3 days** of one-time paid marriage leave for their own wedding, provided at least 15 days' advance notice is given.

Unpaid Leave

Employees who have exhausted their applicable paid leave balances may request unpaid leave of up to 30 days per year, subject to approval from their department head and Human Resources. Extended unpaid leave beyond 30 days is considered on a case-by-case basis and may affect benefit continuity.

5. Compensation & Benefits

Payday Schedule

Salaries are paid monthly via direct bank transfer, credited on the **last working day of each month**. Payslips are made available through NexoraHR by the 2nd working day of the following month. In the event that payday falls on a public holiday or weekend, salaries are credited on the preceding working day.

Salary Structure

Compensation at Nexora Solutions typically consists of a fixed component (basic salary, house rent allowance, and special allowance) and a variable component (performance bonus), as detailed in each employee's individual offer letter and annual compensation statement. Salary revisions are considered annually in April, following the performance review cycle described below.

Health Insurance

Nexora Solutions provides **group medical insurance coverage of ■5,00,000 per year** for every full-time employee, at no cost to the employee. Coverage includes hospitalization, day-care procedures, and pre- and post-hospitalization expenses for 30 and 60 days respectively.

- Employees may add up to 4 dependents (spouse, children, and parents) to the group policy at a subsidized premium, deducted from monthly salary.
- A separate **personal accident insurance** policy of ■10,00,000 is provided to all employees at no cost.
- A **term life insurance** policy equal to 3 times the employee's annual basic salary is provided at no cost, with the employee's nominee named beneficiary.
- Enrollment and claims are managed through the company's insurance partner portal, with HR support available for claim assistance.

Retirement Benefits

Nexora Solutions contributes to Provident Fund (PF) at 12% of basic salary, matched by an equal employee contribution, in accordance with statutory requirements. Employees who complete 5 or more years of continuous service are also eligible for gratuity, calculated as per the applicable statutory formula.

Performance Bonus

Nexora Solutions operates an annual performance bonus program, paid out in **May** following the close of the performance review cycle. Bonus targets are expressed as a percentage of annual basic salary, based on role level:

Role Level	Target Bonus (% of Basic Salary)
Associate / Junior	8%
Mid-Level (2–5 years)	12%
Senior (5+ years)	18%

Role Level	Target Bonus (% of Basic Salary)
Department Head / Leadership	25%

Actual bonus payouts are determined by a combination of individual performance rating (weighted 60%) and overall company performance against annual targets (weighted 40%). Employees must be employed on the date of bonus disbursement and not serving a notice period to be eligible for payout.

Other Benefits

- **Annual learning & development allowance** of ■25,000 per employee, for courses, certifications, or conference attendance relevant to the employee's role.
- **Wellness reimbursement** of ■3,000 per quarter toward gym memberships, fitness classes, or mental health counseling sessions.
- **Internet reimbursement** of ■1,000 per month for employees in hybrid or remote roles.
- **Referral bonus** of ■20,000 for successful employee referrals who complete 90 days of service, paid in the payroll cycle following the referred employee's confirmation.
- **Annual team offsite** and quarterly team lunch budget, coordinated by department heads.

6. Termination & Resignation Policy

Resignation by Employee

Employees who wish to resign are required to submit a written resignation to their manager and Human Resources through NexoraHR. The standard notice period is **30 days** for confirmed employees, and **7 days** for employees still within their probation period.

- Employees in senior or department head roles are required to serve a notice period of **60 days**, as specified in their offer letter, to allow adequate time for transition planning.
- Nexora Solutions may, at its sole discretion, allow an employee to buy out part or all of their notice period by paying an amount equivalent to the basic salary for the unserved notice days, subject to manager and HR approval.
- Employees may also be released early from their notice period at the company's discretion, in which case they will be paid for the full notice period regardless of last working day.

Termination by the Company

Nexora Solutions may terminate employment for reasons including, but not limited to, unsatisfactory performance, redundancy, restructuring, or misconduct.

- **Performance-related termination:** Preceded by a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) of 30 to 60 days, except in cases of gross misconduct. Confirmed employees terminated for performance reasons are entitled to 30 days' notice or pay in lieu of notice.
- **Redundancy / restructuring:** Affected employees are entitled to 30 days' notice or pay in lieu, plus a severance payment of 15 days' basic salary for each completed year of service, capped at 6 months' salary.
- **Gross misconduct:** Includes theft, fraud, harassment, breach of confidentiality, or serious violation of the Code of Conduct. In such cases, the company reserves the right to terminate employment immediately, without notice or pay in lieu, following a documented internal inquiry.

Exit Process

All departing employees, whether resigning or terminated, are required to complete the following exit process:

- **Handover:** Complete a documented handover of ongoing projects, client relationships, and access credentials to the designated successor or manager.
- **Exit interview:** Conducted by Human Resources, typically within the final week of employment, to gather feedback on the employee's experience at Nexora.
- **Clearance:** Return all company property, including laptops, access cards, mobile devices, and any physical documents, no later than the last working day.
- **Final settlement:** Full and final settlement, including any pending salary, unused leave encashment (up to the applicable cap described in Section 4), and reimbursements, is processed within **45 days** of the last working day.
- **Experience letter and relieving letter:** Issued within 10 working days of the completion of the exit process, provided all clearance formalities are complete.

Employees who resign without serving the required notice period, and are not granted a waiver, will have an amount equivalent to the unserved notice period deducted from their final settlement.

7. IT & Security Policy

As a technology company handling sensitive client data, Nexora Solutions maintains strict IT and information security standards. Every employee is responsible for protecting company systems, devices, and data.

Password Policy

- Passwords for all company systems must be a minimum of **12 characters**, including at least one uppercase letter, one lowercase letter, one number, and one special character.
- Passwords must be changed at least every **90 days**, and may not reuse any of the previous 5 passwords.
- **Multi-factor authentication (MFA)** is mandatory for all accounts accessing company email, cloud infrastructure, source code repositories, and client systems.
- Passwords must never be shared with colleagues, written on physical notes at the workstation, or stored in unencrypted files. Approved password managers are provided to all employees for secure storage.
- Accounts will be automatically locked after **5 failed login attempts** and must be unlocked by the IT Help Desk following identity verification.

Device Usage

All employees are issued a company laptop for work purposes. The following standards apply to device usage:

- Company laptops must have full-disk encryption, endpoint protection software, and automatic security updates enabled at all times; these are pre-configured by IT before issuance and must not be disabled.
- Devices must be locked (screen-locked) whenever left unattended, even for brief periods, in both office and remote settings.
- Installation of unauthorized or unlicensed software on company devices is prohibited. Requests for new software should be submitted to the IT Help Desk for review and approval.
- Use of personal USB drives or external storage devices on company laptops is restricted and requires prior IT approval, in order to prevent data leakage and malware exposure.
- Employees using personal devices to access company email or systems ("Bring Your Own Device") must enroll the device in the company's mobile device management (MDM) system, which enforces passcodes and allows remote wipe of company data if the device is lost, stolen, or the employee separates from the company.
- Lost or stolen devices must be reported to the IT Help Desk within **2 hours** of discovery, so that access can be revoked and the device can be remotely locked or wiped.

Data Handling and Confidentiality

- Client data and company confidential information must only be stored on approved company systems (e.g., company cloud storage), never on personal cloud accounts, personal email, or unapproved third-party tools.
- Employees must not forward company or client data to personal email addresses under any circumstances.
- Confidentiality obligations continue to apply after an employee's departure from the company, as set out in the confidentiality agreement signed at the time of hiring.
- Any suspected data breach, phishing attempt, or security incident must be reported to security@nexorasolutions.example immediately, and no later than **24 hours** after discovery.

Acceptable Use of Company Systems

Company email, internet access, and computing resources are provided primarily for business purposes. Limited, reasonable personal use is permitted provided it does not interfere with work responsibilities, consume excessive bandwidth or storage, or violate any other company policy. Nexora Solutions reserves the right to monitor company systems for security and compliance purposes, in accordance with applicable law.

This handbook is periodically reviewed and updated by the Human Resources Department. For questions about any policy in this document, please contact hr@nexorasolutions.example or your HR Business Partner.

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